HomeoClinic User Guide

Covers releases R0 + R1 + R2 + R3 (milestones M0 + M1 + M2 + M3): "Paper replacement".

This guide is cumulative. Each milestone's guide includes everything from the previous milestones plus the new features. This edition (R3) adds on-screen case taking, follow-up visits, and a live Today screen on top of the patient register (R2) and the setup/lock/backup features (R1). Later editions (R4, R5, ...) will add prescriptions and printing, billing, and the repertory.

HomeoClinic is a fully offline desktop application. It makes no network calls of its own: your patient data never leaves your computer, and everything in this guide works with the internet disconnected.

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1. Installing and opening the app (R0)

Ubuntu / Linux

You received one of these files:

- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`** — portable, no installation. 1. Make it executable: right-click → Properties → Permissions → "Allow executing file as program", or in a terminal run `chmod +x HomeoClinic_*.AppImage`. 2. Double-click it (or run `./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`).
- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`** — installs into the system menu. 1. Install it: `sudo apt install ./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`. 2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from your applications menu.

Windows

1. Run the **`.exe`** (NSIS) or **`.msi`** installer and follow the prompts. The app installs per-user; no administrator rights are required.
2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from the Start menu.

What you should see

- The application window opens within a few seconds.
- On a **brand-new installation**, the app opens the **first-run setup wizard** (see section 2).
- On an **already set-up installation**, the app opens the **lock screen** and asks for your PIN (see section 3).

The main application shell has:

- a **top bar** with a patient search box (press **F2** to focus it) and buttons for Help (**F1**) and Lock (**Ctrl+L**);
- a **left navigation** with Today, Patients, Backup and Settings (some items are disabled until later releases add their screens);
- a **status bar** at the bottom showing the save state, the last backup time, and the licence/trial state.

> In R3 the working areas are: setup, lock, the **Today** home (now with live due/overdue lists), the **Patients** register and search, **case taking** and **follow-up visits** (new in R3), and Backup. Prescriptions, billing and the repertory arrive in later releases.

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2. First-run setup wizard (R1)

The first time you open the app on a new computer, the setup wizard runs automatically. It has at most four short steps and should take only a couple of minutes. The language selector at the top is English for this release.

Step 1 — Doctor profile

Enter your professional details. These print on every prescription and receipt in later releases.

- **Full name** (required)
- **Qualification** (required) — e.g. BHMS, MD(Hom)
- **Registration number** and **Council** (required)
- **Phone** and **Email** (optional)
- **Signature image** and **Clinic logo** (optional)

Click **Next**. Required fields that are empty show an inline message under the field.

Step 2 — Clinic profile

- **Clinic name** (required)
- **Address** (required)
- **Default consultation fee** and **Default follow-up fee** (required) — amounts are shown in Indian number format
- **Phone**, **GSTIN**, **Timings** (optional)

Click **Next**.

Step 3 — Security (PIN and recovery code)

1. **Set a PIN** (4 to 6 digits) and **confirm** it. This PIN protects all your patient data.
2. Choose the **auto-lock** time (how many idle minutes before the app locks itself; default 15).
3. After the PIN is confirmed, the app shows a **one-time recovery code**. - **Write it down or click Print.** It is shown only once. - If you ever forget your PIN, this recovery code is the only way back into your data.
4. Tick **"I have saved my recovery code"** to continue.

> **Keep the recovery code safe and separate from the computer.** There is no way to recover your data without either the PIN or the recovery code — this is what keeps patient data private.

Step 4 — Licence

- Select **Start 30-day free trial**. This release uses a built-in **Development trial**; buying and importing a real licence arrives in a later release.

Click **Finish setup**. The app creates your encrypted database, starts the trial, and opens the **Today** screen, unlocked and ready.

> **Setup must be finished before anything else is available.** The rest of the app cannot be reached until you complete the wizard and start the trial here. **Finish setup** is the only way out of the wizard; there is no shortcut that skips the trial. (If you close the app mid-setup, it reopens on the wizard where you left off.)

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3. Locking and unlocking the app (R1)

Your data sits behind a single PIN entry.

When the app locks

- **On every launch** after setup is complete.
- **Automatically** after the idle time you chose (default 15 minutes).
- **On demand** — press **Ctrl+L** or click the **Lock** button in the top bar at any time.

Unlocking

1. Type your **PIN** and press **Enter** (or click **Unlock**).
2. A correct PIN unlocks immediately and returns you to where you were.
3. A wrong PIN shows an inline message and lets you try again — the app never locks you out or wipes anything for a wrong entry.

Forgot your PIN

1. On the lock screen, click **Forgot PIN?**.
2. Enter the **recovery code** from setup, then set and confirm a **new PIN**.
3. Click **Reset PIN**. You can now unlock with the new PIN.

> Unlocking and recovery happen entirely on your computer — no internet is used or required.

Trial status in the status bar (R1)

The status bar shows your licence state, e.g. **"Licence: Trial — expires (N days left)"**. The days-remaining counts down against a tamper-proof clock: setting the computer's date backwards does **not** extend the trial.

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4. Registering patients (R2)

Open **Patients** from the left navigation, then **New patient** (or press **F4**). This opens the registration form (screen S06).

The registration form

- **Name** (required).
- **Age** (required) **or Date of birth** — entering a date of birth fills the age automatically; otherwise type the age directly (it may be estimated).
- **Sex**, **Mobile**, **Alternate mobile**, **Address**, **City**, **Occupation**, **Marital status**, **Blood group**, **Referred by** — all optional.
- A **patient code** (e.g. `HC-000123`) is assigned automatically with your clinic prefix. Codes are **never reused**, even after a patient is deleted and restored.
- Required fields validate inline; fees and money show in Indian number format.

Patient photo (R2)

In the form you can attach a photo two ways:

- **Choose file** — pick an image file from disk.
- **Use webcam** — capture from the computer's default camera. The app asks for camera access; if a camera is unavailable or access is denied, it tells you and you can fall back to a file.

You can **remove**, **retake**, or **swap** the photo (file ↔ webcam) before or after saving — the photo updates with the patient record.

Duplicate warning

Before saving, if another patient matches on **name + mobile** or **name + date of birth** (including common Indian-name spelling variants), the form shows a **duplicate warning** listing the possible matches. It does not block you — you decide whether it's truly a new patient.

Click **Save**. The new patient is stored and becomes **findable immediately** in search.

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5. Finding patients — global search (R2)

Press **F2** or **Ctrl+K** (or click the top-bar search box) to open the global search overlay from any screen. It finds patients from the first character you type — no need to choose a field.

What it matches

- **Name** — any word prefix, e.g. typing `ram ku` finds "Ramesh Kumar".
- **Patient ID** — full code or just the digits, e.g. `123` finds `HC-000123`.
- **Mobile** — any 4 or more consecutive digits, ignoring `+91` and spaces.
- **City** and **family member name**.
- **Phonetic / spelling variants** of Indian names — e.g. `sarma` finds "Sharma", `laxmi` finds "Lakshmi", `mohd` finds "Mohammad". Exact matches always rank above phonetic ones.

Using it

- Results update as you type and each row shows photo, name, ID, age/sex, mobile, city, last visit and dues.
- Use **Up/Down** to move and **Enter** to open the patient's dashboard. **Enter** on an exact ID or mobile match opens that patient directly.
- When the box is empty, your **last 20 opened patients** are shown.
- Search stays fast — results appear in well under a tenth of a second even with tens of thousands of patients.

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6. The patient list and filters (R2)

Open **Patients** to see the full list with a filter panel (screen S05).

- **Filters available now:** last visit older than N days, next follow-up (today / overdue / date range), age range, sex, city, and "has dues". Filters combine together; results are sortable by name, ID, last visit and next follow-up.
- **Export CSV** writes the current filtered, sorted list to a file.
- Some filters (by remedy, diagnosis, potency, case-note text, tags, and saved filters) are shown but **disabled** — they switch on in later releases once more case and prescription data exists.

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7. The patient dashboard (R2)

Clicking a patient (from search or the list) opens their dashboard (screen S07):

- **Demographics banner** — name, code, **age**/sex, mobile, city, referred by, photo — plus any **allergies / alerts**. The **age updates itself** over time from the date of birth, so it is always current.
- **Family** — linked family members with quick-switch.
- **Take case / Follow-up** — starts the first case, or (once a first case is saved) a **Follow-up**. After the first case is recorded, the plain "New visit" is greyed out so you don't accidentally start a second first case — use **Follow-up** instead (see sections 8 and 9). New in R3.
- **Visit timeline** builds up as you record visits (R3).

A **dues** area and a **Clear dues** button appear as **disabled placeholders** — automatic fee totals and marking dues paid arrive with the billing release (R5).

From the dashboard you can **Edit** the patient, **Export** their record (PDF or JSON), or move them to the **recycle bin**.

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8. Taking a case (R3, new)

From a patient's dashboard, click **Take case** (or **New visit** for a patient with no prior visit; shortcut **F5**). This opens the case form (screen S08) — the on-screen replacement for the paper case sheet. It is one **rich text editor per complaint** that works like a word processor: you type freely, and structured data drops **into the same document as editable tables**, so the entire case lives in one place.

The editor — one document for everything

- Each complaint is **one rich editable document**. Type the case into it as free text, format as you like, exactly as you would write on a sheet — and everything you record (vitals, family history, prescription, …) is inserted **into this same document** as a table.
- **Add entry** stamps a **date header** and starts a fresh block beneath it. The document is a **running dated log**: every time you open the case (and on every follow-up) you add a new dated entry under the previous ones, so the whole history of the complaint stays together in one scroll.
- **Everything is editable in place** — all the text, and every cell of every table, can be clicked into and changed at any time (tab between cells like a spreadsheet).

Record buttons — insert a section as a table

A row of **Record** buttons sits above the editor. Each opens a small pop-up; when you press **Record**, it inserts that section **into the current dated entry** as an editable table, preceded by a **numbered heading** and a **full-width separator line** so each section reads as a clear block:

- **Record vitals** — enter **blood pressure as two fields, systolic and diastolic**, plus pulse, weight and height; **BMI is computed live**. Inserts a vitals table.
- **Record modalities** — aggravations / ameliorations, as a table.
- **Record family history** — a pop-up with **Maternal** and **Paternal** tabs; on Record it inserts a tidy **two-column table (Maternal | Paternal)**.
- **Record physical generals** — appetite, thirst, cravings, thermal state, and **Constitution**, **Diet**, **Sun aggravation (Yes/No)** and **Notes**.
- **Record investigations** — what you have **Suggested** and what the patient has **Submitted**.
- **Add prescription** — a medicine table with columns **Medicine, Potency, Dosage, Instructions**. In this release the prescription is a **preview**: it is saved with the case, but formatted printing arrives with the prescription release (R4).

Each inserted section is **numbered in order**, so the case always reads in a fixed chronological sequence. On a **follow-up** the buttons read **Update vitals / Update prescription / …** and insert a fresh table under the new dated entry rather than overwriting the earlier one.

Uploading lab and scan reports

Use the **Investigations** upload control to attach a **PDF or image** (ultrasound, CT, blood report, etc.). Each report shows a **PDF / Image** badge and an optional caption; you can **open** it or **remove** it (with confirmation). Reports are stored **encrypted** on your computer and never leave it.

Saving — autosave plus a Save button

- The case **autosaves every 2 seconds and whenever you pause**; the status shows "Saving..." then **"Saved hh:mm"**.
- There is also an explicit **Save** button. Pressing it forces an immediate save and confirms **"Saved"** — for peace of mind that the case is written.
- If the app closes — or the computer crashes — **mid-typing**, reopening the case restores the last saved content (text **and** the inserted tables) with **nothing lost**.

> The **"Send to repertory"** action is not shown yet; it switches on when the repertory ships in a later release.

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9. Follow-up visits (R3, new)

Once a patient has a saved first case, the dashboard offers **Follow-up** (the plain "New visit" is greyed out, because the first case is already recorded — so you can't start a second first case by mistake). Click **Follow-up** to record a return consultation.

A follow-up **reopens the very same document** as the case, already filled with the previous entries and everything you recorded:

- The editor **pre-loads** with the earlier dated entries, the prior complaint text, and the tables you recorded before — **including the family history** and every other recorded section, so nothing is lost between visits.
- Click **Add entry** to stamp **today's date** and write what has changed.
- The Record buttons now read **Update vitals / Update family history / Update prescription / …**; each inserts a fresh table under the new dated entry, so you can see the earlier readings and the new ones together.
- **Next follow-up**: set the next appointment with the quick buttons **7d / 15d / 1m / 2m** or a **custom date**. The scheduled date is shown on the visit and puts the patient onto the Today screen for that date (section 10).
- Like the case, the follow-up **autosaves** and has an explicit **Save** button.

When you finish and save, the patient's **Today / home screen updates** to reflect the follow-up you entered — if you scheduled a next appointment the patient appears under **Due today / Overdue** on the right date, and the visit shows under **Registered today**.

> The **progress chart** and formatted **Prescribe / print** actions are not active yet; they switch on in later releases (the prescription table you add in the box is saved as a preview in the meantime).

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10. The Today screen (R3 — now live)

Today is the home screen (press **F3**). From R3 it shows three live lists, driven by the follow-up dates you set:

- **Due today** — patients whose next follow-up falls on today's date.
- **Overdue** — patients whose follow-up date has passed (most overdue first).
- **Registered today** — the visits recorded today.

Each row shows the patient's photo, name, code and age/sex; click or press **Enter** to open their dashboard. Set a follow-up date on a visit and the patient appears under **Due today** on that date, then moves to **Overdue** afterwards.

Today also shows the **backup warning banner** when your last good backup is more than 7 days old (see section 11). The licence-renewal reminder becomes live in a later release.

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11. Backing up your data (R1)

Backup becomes available **after** you finish the first-run setup (section 2). Once setup is complete, open **Backup** from the left navigation (or click the "Last backup" chip in the status bar).

Back up now (to a folder or USB drive)

1. Under **Back up now**, choose a destination with **Choose folder...** or **Use USB drive...**.
2. Enter a **backup password** (at least 8 characters). The first time, you also confirm it.
3. Optionally tick **Remember on this PC** so scheduled backups never ask for the password again on this computer.
4. Click **Back up now**.

The app writes a single encrypted file, `*.hcbak`, containing your database and attachments (patients, their photos, and now your cases and visits). After writing, it verifies the file (checksum + decrypt test).

> The backup password is **separate** from your app PIN. You need this password to restore the backup on another computer, so store it safely.

Automatic daily backups

- Automatic daily backup keeps the last **14 daily**, **8 weekly** and **12 monthly** copies, pruning older ones.
- It runs on app close or the first launch of the day and uses your remembered password, so it never interrupts you.

Backup health

- The screen and the status-bar chip show when the **last good backup** ran.
- If the last successful backup is **more than 7 days old**, a warning banner appears prompting you to back up.

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12. Restoring from a backup (R1)

Use this to recover data, or to move to a new computer (install HomeoClinic on the new PC, then restore).

1. On the **Backup** screen, under **Restore from a backup**, click **Choose backup file (.hcbak)...**.
2. **Step 1 — File and password:** select the `.hcbak` file and enter its backup password. A wrong password is refused here and the wizard does not continue.
3. **Step 2 — Preview:** the app shows what the backup contains (counts and dates) **without changing anything yet**.
4. **Step 3 — Confirm:** click **Restore**. Before replacing anything, the app takes a **safety copy of your current data**, then swaps in the restored data. A mistaken restore is therefore recoverable.

After restore, your doctor and clinic profile, **all patients** (with photos) and **all cases and visits** come back.

> Upgrading from an older version keeps your data: installing a new release over an existing one migrates your database automatically and your previous backups still open.
>
> Backup and restore perform **no network calls** and work fully offline.

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13. Quick reference — keyboard shortcuts (R0–R3)

Key	Action
F1	Help
F2 / Ctrl+K	Focus / open global patient search
F3	Today
F4	New patient
F5	New visit for the open patient (case or follow-up)
Alt+←	Back (up one level: case/follow-up → dashboard → list → Today)
Ctrl+= / Ctrl+-	Zoom text and layout in / out
Ctrl+0	Reset zoom
Ctrl+L	Lock the app now
Up / Down	Move through search results / lists
Enter	Open the selected patient / confirm the current step / unlock
Esc	Close a dialog or the search overlay (never discards data)

> **Back** is always in the **same place** (top of the screen) on every screen, and **Alt+←** does the same from the keyboard. Going back never discards your work — the case is already autosaved.
>
> **Zoom** scales both the text and the layout, so you can make the whole app larger on a big consulting-room screen or smaller to fit more in. When the window is **maximised / full-screen, the layout now fills the whole screen** rather than sitting in a narrow centred column.

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14. Privacy and safety notes (R1–R3)

- **Offline only.** HomeoClinic makes no network connections of its own and opens no listening ports.
- **Encrypted at rest.** Your database, patient photos and case records are encrypted; the key is derived from your PIN.

- **Autosave never loses clinical work** — cases and follow-ups save continuously and restore after a crash or an accidental close.
- **No data in logs.** Diagnostic logs never contain patient details.
- **Never lost by accident.** Patients are soft-deleted to a 30-day recycle bin; permanent deletion asks for your PIN.
- **Your data is always recoverable** with your PIN or your recovery code, and always **exportable** (per-patient PDF/JSON, filtered-list CSV, or a full encrypted backup).

Appendix — what is NOT in this release

The following arrive in later milestones and are intentionally absent or shown as **disabled placeholders** in R3: formatted prescriptions and printing (the prescription table you add to the case is saved as a preview only), billing — including the **dues** total and **Clear dues** — and reports, the repertory / Materia Medica and "Send to repertory", per-complaint progress charts, buying/importing a real licence, custom case-template editing, voice dictation and the body diagram, and the appointment book. When those ship, this guide will be extended to cover them.

HomeoClinic User Guide — R3 edition (M0 + M1 + M2 + M3). Generated from `documents/user-guide/HomeoClinic-User-Guide-R3.md`*.*